

# Acme Corporation — Employee Lifecycle SOP

Standard Operating Procedures for Onboarding, Offboarding, and Role Transfers

Acme Corporation | Human Resources Department | Effective: January 1, 2026 | Version 4.1

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## Overview & Scope of This Document

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) document is the definitive operational guide for the Acme Corp HR, IT, and Payroll teams. It defines the precise, step-by-step procedures for executing three of the most critical and legally sensitive employee lifecycle events: Onboarding, Offboarding, and Internal Role Transfers.

All HR Business Partners, IT Coordinators, and Payroll Analysts are required to follow the procedures outlined herein without deviation. Any exception to these procedures must be approved in writing by the VP of Human Resources.

**IMPORTANT:** Failure to follow these SOPs can result in data security incidents, regulatory non-compliance, incorrect payroll processing, and potential legal liability for Acme Corp.

## Part 1: The Complete Employee Onboarding SOP

### *Phase 1: Pre-Boarding Initiation (Day -14)*

Trigger: HR Business Partner receives a countersigned Offer Letter from the Talent Acquisition team.

Action 1.1 — Create HRIS Record: HR Partner creates the new hire's record in Workday. All fields, including job title, department, manager, start date, and compensation band, must be populated with 100% accuracy before any downstream actions are triggered.

Action 1.2 — Send Pre-Boarding Packet: HR Partner dispatches the electronic pre-boarding packet via DocuSign. This packet contains all mandatory documents: NDA, IP Assignment Agreement, Code of Conduct, I-9, direct deposit form, and emergency contact form.

Action 1.3 — Verify Document Completion: HR Partner must confirm receipt and verify the legal validity of all signed documents within 3 business days of dispatch. If the candidate does not return the signed NDA within 5 business days of dispatch, their start date must be put on hold and the hiring manager must be notified immediately.

Action 1.4 — Trigger IT Provisioning Ticket: Once all documents are verified, HR Partner marks the 'Pre-boarding Checklist' as 'Complete' in Workday. This automatically triggers an IT Provisioning Ticket in Jira Service Management. The ticket is assigned to IT Logistics with a 5-business-day SLA.

## ***Phase 2: IT Provisioning (Days -7 to -1)***

Trigger: Receipt of Jira IT Provisioning Ticket from Workday integration.

Action 2.1 — Hardware Procurement and Configuration: IT Logistics procures the correct hardware based on the employee's role as defined in the Jira ticket: - Software Engineers: 16-inch MacBook Pro (M-series, 32GB RAM, 1TB SSD) + peripherals - Data Analysts: 14-inch MacBook Pro (16GB RAM, 512GB SSD) + peripherals - Business/Operations Roles: 13-inch Dell XPS (16GB RAM) + peripherals

Action 2.2 — MDM Enrollment: All laptops must be enrolled in the Jamf MDM platform before shipment. IT must verify MDM enrollment is successful and that the Acme Base Image v4.2 has been applied.

Action 2.3 — Account Creation: IT provisions accounts in Google Workspace, Slack, and Okta SSO. The employee's Okta account must be in a 'pending activation' state (not fully active) until Day 1.

Action 2.4 — Role-Specific Access Ticket: The hiring manager is required to submit a separate 'Role-Specific Software Access' ticket in Jira Service Desk at least 48 hours before the start date. This covers tools like GitHub Enterprise, AWS Console access, Salesforce, Tableau, etc.

Action 2.5 — Hardware Shipment: IT ships the configured laptop to the employee's registered address with FedEx Priority Overnight to ensure arrival by Day -1.

## Part 1 (Continued): Day 1 and Beyond

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### *Phase 3: Day One Execution*

Action 3.1 — Welcome Email (08:00 AM): The hiring manager must dispatch a 'Welcome Email' to the departmental distribution list at precisely 8:00 AM local time on the employee's first day. The email must include the employee's full name, job title, team they are joining, a brief professional background, and a personal note from the manager.

Action 3.2 — HR Orientation Session (10:00 AM): The new hire must attend the mandatory 2-hour HR Orientation session at 10:00 AM. This session, conducted by the HR Onboarding Specialist, covers: company mission and values; benefits enrollment and deadlines; IT security policies and acceptable use; HRIS navigation (Workday); and an introduction to Acme Corp's performance management cycle.

Action 3.3 — Workday Completion (by 3:00 PM): By 3:00 PM on Day 1, the employee must log into Workday and complete their W-4 federal tax withholding form, state tax withholding form (where applicable), and configure their direct deposit banking information.

Action 3.4 — IT Setup Session: IT schedules a 1-hour virtual setup session with the new hire on Day 1 afternoon. During this session: Okta Verify MFA is configured on the employee's mobile device; the employee generates and submits their GPG key (for engineers); and the employee clones the acme-bootstrap repository to configure their local dev environment (engineers only).

### *Phase 4: Week 1 Mandatory Completions*

By the end of the employee's first week (Day 5), the following must be completed: - DEI Training Module completed in the Learning Management System (LMS) - Security Awareness Training completed in the LMS - Benefits enrollment submitted in Workday (Deadline is 30 days, but Week 1 is the target) - First 1-on-1 meeting with direct manager held - Verified tool access: logged into all provisioned systems successfully

The HR Onboarding Specialist must conduct a 'Week 1 Check-in' call with the new hire on Day 5 to confirm all items above are complete and address any outstanding issues.

## Part 2: The Complete Employee Offboarding SOP

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### *Step 1: Resignation Receipt and Ticket Creation*

Trigger: HR Business Partner receives a written resignation letter or is notified of an involuntary termination decision.

Action 1.1 — Acknowledge Resignation: HR Partner sends a formal written acknowledgment of the resignation to the employee within 24 hours, confirming the final day of employment.

Action 1.2 — Create Offboarding Master Ticket: HR Partner creates an 'Offboarding Master Ticket' in Jira Service Management. This ticket automatically creates linked sub-tickets assigned to: IT (Access Revocation), IT Logistics (Asset Recovery), Payroll (Final Pay Processing), and Facilities (Badge Deactivation).

### ***Step 2: Knowledge Transfer (By Day -3 of Last Day)***

Action 2.1 — KTD Responsibility: The departing employee's direct manager is fully accountable for ensuring a Knowledge Transfer Document (KTD) is completed and saved to the departmental shared drive in Google Workspace at least 3 business days before the employee's final day.

The KTD must include: a list of all active projects and their current status; descriptions of recurring duties and relevant procedural knowledge; key internal and external stakeholder contacts; location of critical files, credentials (using the vault, never plaintext), and documentation.

### ***Step 3: IT Access Revocation Scheduling***

Action 3.1 — Scheduling: Upon receipt of the IT Offboarding sub-ticket, the IT Security Operations Center (SOC) must schedule automated access revocation across all platforms. The revocation date and time must be set to exactly 5:00 PM local time on the employee's final day. Access must not be left active after this time under any circumstances.

Action 3.2 — Scope of Revocation: Revocation must cover: Okta SSO (cascades to all integrated SaaS apps), Google Workspace (email suspended, not deleted), Slack, GitHub Enterprise (removed from all organization repositories), AWS IAM access, Datadog, Corporate VPN certificates, and all physical door access control systems.

Action 3.3 — Data Preservation: The employee's Google Workspace email and Drive data must be transferred to their direct manager's ownership for a 30-day review period before permanent archiving to cold storage.

### ***Step 4: Asset Recovery***

Action 4.1 — In-Office Employees: The employee must physically hand over all assets to IT Logistics before the Exit Interview begins. IT Logistics will verify each item against the asset registry and confirm receipt in Jira.

Action 4.2 — Remote Employees: HR must send a pre-paid, insured FedEx return shipping box and packing instructions to the employee's home address no later than 5 business days before the final day. The employee must ship all assets on their last day. IT Logistics tracks the return and updates the Jira ticket upon receipt.

### ***Step 5: Exit Interview and Final Payroll***

Action 5.1 — Exit Interview: HR must schedule and conduct a 30-minute structured Exit Interview via Zoom on or before the employee's final day. The feedback is entered into a confidential HR database and reviewed quarterly by the VP of HR.

Action 5.2 — Final Paycheck: Payroll must process the final paycheck within 48 hours of the termination date. The final pay must include all regular wages owed, plus a payout of all unused, accrued PTO days in accordance with state law requirements.

Action 5.3 — Laptop Wipe: IT Logistics must perform a DoD 5220.22-M standard secure wipe on all returned storage media before any device is re-issued or disposed of.

## Part 3: The Internal Role Transfer SOP

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### ***Step 1: Transfer Approval Confirmation***

Trigger: HR receives a completed 'Internal Transfer Request Form' signed by both the transferring manager and the receiving manager.

Action 1.1 — Eligibility Check: HR Business Partner verifies the employee meets all eligibility requirements (12 months in role, good standing, not on PIP). If ineligible, HR notifies both managers within 2 business days.

Action 1.2 — Set Effective Date: HR, both managers, and the employee agree on a formal Transfer Effective Date. A transition window of up to 14 days is permitted.

### ***Step 2: Knowledge Transfer and Handoff***

Action 2.1: The transferring employee must complete a full KTD for their current role covering all active projects, recurring duties, and key contacts. This must be approved by the current manager 3 days before the effective date.

Action 2.2: The current team lead must reallocate all of the transferring employee's open tickets and tasks to other team members in Jira before the effective date.

### ***Step 3: IT Access Modification***

Action 3.1 — IT Notification: HR must file an 'Access Modification Ticket' in Jira, specifying the exact access to be removed and the exact access to be granted. IT IAM must action this ticket before the Transfer Effective Date.

Action 3.2 — Access Removal: Remove employee from all department-specific Google Groups, Slack channels, shared drives, and IAM security groups associated with the former team.

Action 3.3 — Access Addition: Provision the employee with access to the new department's Google Groups, Slack channels, shared drives, and any role-specific tools (which may require a new software license request).

### ***Step 4: Compensation Adjustment and Documentation***

Action 4.1: HR Compensation team must review the role's salary band and determine if an adjustment is warranted. If a salary change is approved, HR must draft a new Compensation and Title Adjustment Letter.

Action 4.2: The employee must sign the Compensation and Title Adjustment Letter before the Transfer Effective Date. The signed document is uploaded to Workday as the official HR record.